

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in

Technology has pretty much invaded every single aspect of life there is, just as we told you it would over a decade ago. Sadly, along with this popularity of technology, comes the tendency to misuse tech jargon and obfuscate truth. It's not just individual companies you can blame, it's the industry as a whole, because no one wants to be left behind... However, the result is that you are bombarded with what we're calling "bull" but is really a polite shortening of the term bullshit, because often, you're being sold exactly that as an added feature, or sometimes, even being sold it at a premium. So we asked ourselves what we could do to clean up the poo that's being thrown at you, and the answer was this cover story. We're going to tackle a few features that we think are, essentially just bullshit, and rate them on a turd scale between one and five turds (obviously, five turds being the worst). We're merely scratching the surface here, and we're sure you might come up with some suggestions of your own. If you do, write in to us and let us know. Now to the dung-mobile pooman, we've got turd ratings to give away! (We hope you will forgive our shameless toilet humour this one time).

SMARTPHONES

SPECIFICATIONS WARS



What's the first thing you do when you hear that a new phone is being launched? Most will probably say, "look up the specs", and that's a wise move, usually, but in the past few years, there seem to be some turds creeping in. For one thing, all specs are just being raised, and that's not always a good thing. Sure it feels like it's better to have more RAM, battery life, megapixel count, processor speed, amount of storage, etc, but is it worth the extra money you're charged for it? That's debatable. The problem is that the difference between the specs sheet and real world performance is increasing. Having a CPU with more cores isn't really worth it unless the software can make use of them, or else you just paid extra for useless cores. Sure, the software or apps that use 8 cores properly might be here in

a year or two, but by then everything else about your phone will be old and you will need to upgrade again, and spend premium once again! It's why a phone made by a company that writes their own software might perform far better with 3/4 GB of RAM than another phone with 6/8 GB of RAM. Sometimes "on-paper" phones look good, but really the spec sheet is only good for wiping you-know-what.

WIRELESS CHARGING



Wireless usually means no contact, but this isn't that. Wireless charging involves you spending even more money than your already expensive wireless-charging-capable-phone to buy a mat that uses a wire to connect to a power source, on which you then place your phone, and rub your hands in glee while your phone takes far, far longer to charge than if you'd

just connected the wire directly to the phone instead. Hooray for this wireless crap! Because you can sometimes also charge some wireless headphones and a very limited set of devices on the "wireless charging" pad, we've give it three turds, or else it would get more... much more!



Look! No wires! Oh wait... nevermind...

SLOW MOTION VIDEO



Don't get us wrong, we like the idea of cellphone cameras being capable of higher frame capture rates, which means lovely slow-mo playback. We're not pooed-off by that, we're complaining about the fact that there's just no standard for it. Whether you buy a top